

PRD for Ola's Community Impact Rides Feature

Problem Statement

Ola's mission is to improve urban transportation while also fostering a sense of social responsibility. Introducing **Community Impact Rides** allows users to make a positive social impact with every ride they take. This feature enables users to support local community initiatives, donate a portion of their fare to charity, and view the transparency of the impact made.

Ola's ride-sharing app serves millions of users, many of whom are socially conscious and desire to contribute to local causes. However, there is currently no direct way to incorporate community-focused initiatives into the ride-sharing experience. By integrating a donation system and showcasing local social impact, we aim to build a more socially responsible brand while offering a more meaningful experience to our riders.

Current Scenario

Currently, Ola provides basic ride-sharing services but lacks features that directly tie users' actions to social causes. While Ola may support CSR initiatives, users don't have a clear path to engage directly in charitable efforts through the platform.

Limitation/ Challenges

- Lack of transparency in the social impact of the service.
- Users are not always aware of the potential for their rides to contribute to social causes.
- There is no direct integration of charitable causes into the app interface.

Objectives/Goals

Business Objectives

Objective 1: Increase user engagement by offering a socially responsible feature that resonates with a growing market segment of eco-conscious and charitable riders.

Objective 2: Build brand loyalty by allowing users to feel more connected to their community and the causes they care about.

Objective 3: Drive a positive public perception of the Ola brand as a socially responsible company.

User Objectives

Objective 1: Users want to have a direct, transparent way of contributing to their local community via the app.

Objective 2: Users seek social impact with minimal effort and would appreciate a seamless donation system.

Objective 3: Users want a fun and engaging way to support local causes through gamification.

User Personas

Persona 1: Socially Conscious Millennial

- **Background:** A 28-year-old urban professional who actively supports social causes and prefers brands with a strong CSR focus.
- **Needs:** Wants to integrate social responsibility into everyday actions (e.g., transportation).
- **Frustrations:** Doesn't know which companies support causes and feels guilty about not being more proactive.
- **Goals:** Wants to easily contribute to local charities without much effort.

Persona 2: Busy Working Parent

- **Background:** A 40-year-old parent who is always on the go, using ride-sharing for convenience and efficiency.
- **Needs:** Quick, easy-to-use solutions that don't interfere with their busy lifestyle.
- **Frustrations:** Feels disconnected from social causes because they have limited time to engage.
- **Goals:** Would like a simple, automatic way to contribute to the community while managing their hectic schedule.

Persona 3: Eco-Conscious Young Professional

- **Background:** A 25-year-old who values sustainability and is an advocate for environmental and social causes.

- **Needs:** Wants to reduce their carbon footprint and support causes that align with their values.
- **Frustrations:** Feels frustrated that their lifestyle doesn't do enough to help the environment.
- **Goals:** Wants to make a tangible positive impact with every ride.

Persona 4: Community Volunteer

- **Background:** A 35-year-old active volunteer who spends their free time helping local causes and wants to encourage others to do the same.
 - **Needs:** Needs a platform that connects them to opportunities to further their efforts in supporting the community.
 - **Frustrations:** Feels that ride-sharing companies can do more to foster community engagement.
 - **Goals:** Wants to support causes directly through the platforms they already use.
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Prioritize One Persona

Priority Persona: Socially Conscious Millennial

Rationale:

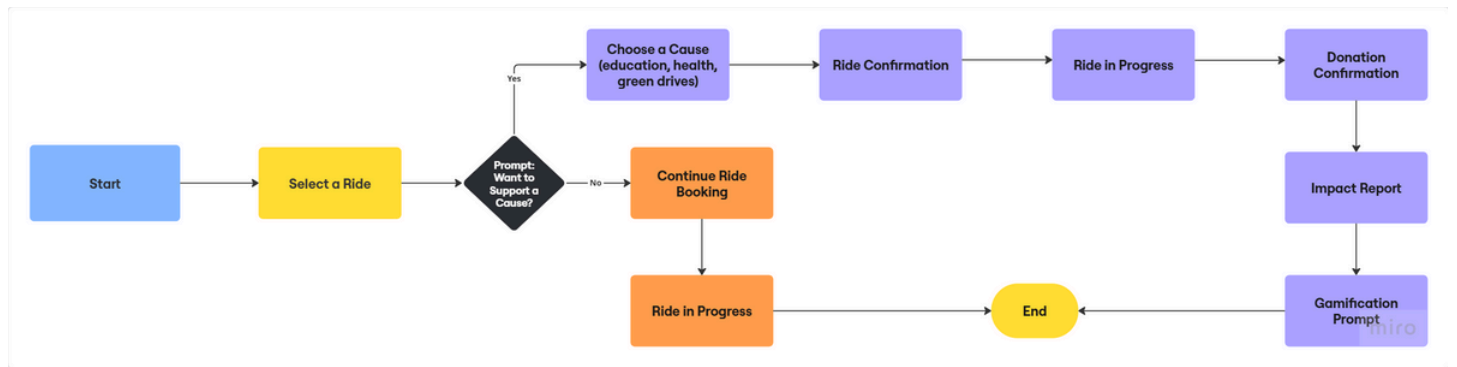
This persona is likely to be the most engaged with social causes, has disposable income, and is digitally savvy. They actively look for ways to contribute to social and environmental causes, and their engagement could drive the adoption of the **Community Impact Rides** feature.

User Stories

The User stories below are for the “Socially Conscious Millennial” User Persona

- *As a socially conscious millennial, I want to see a list of local charitable initiatives I can support, so that I can easily choose causes I care about while booking my ride.*
- *As a socially conscious millennial, I want to see how much of my fare goes toward the charity, so I can track the impact of my contribution.*
- *As a socially conscious millennial, I want to receive rewards or recognition for contributing, so I feel motivated to keep using this feature.*

User Flow



User flow can be viewed using the below link

https://miro.com/app/board/uXjVI3F1qYE=?share_link_id=915142422497

Requirements

Technical Requirements

1) Integration with Ola's Payment System for Seamless Donation Processing

- Integrate donation logic into Ola's existing payment gateway (like Razorpay/Stripe).
- Allow micro-donations (e.g., ₹5–₹50) to be bundled with the final ride fare.
- Donation to be auto-deducted at the time of ride payment, with user opt-in.

2) API to Pull Data About Local Charities and Causes

- Create or integrate with an NGO/charity directory API.
- **Fetch real-time data:** names, logos, descriptions, target goals, current progress, etc.
- Support geolocation filters to show only local initiatives to the rider.

3) Real-time Updates and Transparency for Donations and Community Goals

- Real-time tracking of how much has been donated toward each cause.
- Users should be able to see updated statistics after each ride.
- Use analytics APIs or dashboards (Firebase, Power BI, or custom backend) to manage this data.

Design Requirements

1) Simple, Intuitive UI That Encourages Donations Without Disruption

- The donation prompt should be lightweight and optional.
- It should appear after ride selection but before payment - just like tip prompts.
- Use easy toggle or one -click selections for cause/donation amount.

2) Eco-Friendly Theme with Green Color Accents

- Use visual branding (green hues, leaf icons, eco - symbols) to indicate the purpose.
- Colors should not conflict with Ola's core theme - use soft green accents.
- Visually appealing cards for causes and impact reports.

3) Visual Elements to Highlight Users' Contribution Impact

- Use infographics: progress bars, donation meters, and badges to celebrate the user's contribution.
- Include a thank - you animation or emoji (like 🎉 or 🌱) after successful donation.
- Display “Your Impact Summary” with visual cues like tree icons, people icons, etc.

Functional Requirements

1) Ability for users to select a cause and donate a portion of their fare.

- **Cause Selection and Donation Flow:** According to the User Flow, After choosing a ride, users are prompted to opt-in for a donation.
- **Donation Options:**
 - Fixed amounts (e.g., ₹5, ₹10, ₹20)
 - Percentage of fare (e.g., 2%, 5%)
- **Cause Selection:**
 - Display a list of verified local causes/NGOs based on user's location.
 - Each cause should include a name, short description, logo, and target.
 - Option to auto-select a cause (based on priority needs) for faster checkout.
- **User Control:**
 - Donation is optional.
 - User can toggle donation ON/OFF anytime from app settings.

2) Real-Time Progress Tracker

- **Goal Visualization:**
 - Show real-time progress bars for each community initiative (e.g., "Clean Lakes Mission - 65% Funded").
 - “Impact Cards” after donation (e.g., "Your donation helped plant 3 trees 🌱").
- **User's Personal Impact Dashboard:**
 - Lifetime donations total
 - Number of causes supported
 - View breakdown by cause, month, or city
- **Cause Page Details:**
 - Total funds raised vs target goal
 - Total number of contributors

- Updates or images shared by the NGO

3) Gamification and Incentives

- **Badges & Titles:**

- First-Time Donor – “Community Starter 🌟”
- Recurring Donor – “Social Champion 🏆”
- Location-based – “Hyderabad Hero 🌍”

- **Leaderboard (Optional Feature):**

- Weekly Top Donors in city or neighborhood
- Anonymous or username-based entries

- **Level-Up System:**

- Points awarded per rupee donated
- Unlock levels like:
 - Level 1: Donor
 - Level 2: Supporter
 - Level 3: Hero
 - Level 4: Change-Maker

- **Social Sharing:**

- After donating, allow users to share their impact badge or certificate on WhatsApp, Instagram, or LinkedIn.

Non Functional Requirements

1. Performance and Scalability

- The system should support high concurrent user traffic, especially during peak hours (e.g., festivals, weekends).
- Donation processing should not cause any delay in ride booking or payment confirmation.
- Use of load balancers and caching mechanisms to handle surge traffic.
- Latency goal: Less than 2 seconds for end-to-end donation processing (selection to confirmation).

2. Data Privacy and Protection

- Comply with India’s Data Protection Bill and global standards like GDPR, ensuring users’ personal and financial data is handled with care.
- Data related to donation history, ride history, and cause preferences should be encrypted both in transit and at rest.
- Implement role-based access control (RBAC) so only authorized personnel can access sensitive data.

3. Secure Payment Integration

- Integrate with Ola's existing payment infrastructure to ensure PCI DSS compliance for all donations.
- All donation transactions should go through secure gateways (e.g., Razorpay, Stripe, Paytm) using tokenized payments.
- Provide users with e-receipts and donation certificates for transparency and tax documentation.

4. Reliability & Availability

- 99.9% uptime target for donation and impact tracking services.
- Implement failover mechanisms to ensure community impact data and donation options are still available during partial outages.
- Conduct regular backups of donation databases and NGO data.

5. Auditability and Transparency

- Maintain an audit log of all donations linked to user ID, ride ID, and transaction ID.
- NGOs and users should be able to view how donations are distributed and used.
- Provide regular reports and updates to internal stakeholders and partners.

Prototype

Ride Selection Page

logo

Connaught Place, New Delhi

India Gate, New Delhi

Select Ride Type

Mini

₹150

10 min

Prime Sedan

₹250

8 min

At

₹1

15

Fare Details

Base fare

₹100

Distance (5 km)

₹35

Time estimate

₹15

Total

₹150

Book Mini - ₹150

Home

Rides

Explore

Donate

Profile

Cause Selection Page

Choose a Cause to Support

Select a local cause that resonates with you. Your donation will directly support their important work in our community.

Green Earth Foundation

Working to protect local forests and waterways through conservation...

Learn More

Riverside Homeless Shelter

Providing emergency housing, meals, and support services to individuals...

Learn More

Happy Paws Animal Rescue

Rescuing, rehabilitating, and finding forever homes for abandoned and...

Learn More

Bright Future Youth Center

Empowering at-risk youth through

Continue

Donation Confirmation Page

Review & Confirm

Green Earth Foundation

Working to protect local forests and waterways through conservation projects and community education programs.

Choose Donation Amount

₹5

₹10

₹15

₹20

₹5

₹100

Fare Summary

Base Fare

₹120

Donation

₹5

Total

₹125

Green Earth Foundation

Skip

Confirm Donation

Post-Ride Summary

Your Impact Report

Thank You!

Your donation makes a real difference

Social Supporter

Level 1

Your Contribution

View My Impact

Share

 What If...	 Scenario	 Solution/Feature Adjustment
 What if a user wants to donate more than the fixed fare %?	A user may wish to donate ₹50 instead of the standard 10%	Add a “Custom Amount” slider or quick-pick options (₹10, ₹25, ₹50) on the donation screen
 What if there are no local causes in the user’s area?	Rural or remote users may not see relevant causes	Display national causes or show “Most Supported Causes” from nearby cities
 What if a user permanently disables the donation prompt?	Users may find the prompt repetitive	Add toggle in profile settings under “Community Preferences” to re-enable/disable at will
 What if the donation payment fails?	Network or gateway issues can interrupt donation flow	Display a message: “Your ride is confirmed. We'll retry your donation in the background.” Send confirmation once processed
 What if the app version doesn’t support this feature?	Older versions may not show donation prompt	Display an update banner: “Enable ride-based donations with our latest update!”

Success Metrics

Metric	Frequency	Baseline	Target (6 months)	Why It Matters
User Adoption Rate	Monthly	0%	30% of active users toggle the feature	Indicates interest in socially impactful mobility
Donation Participation	Weekly	10%	40% of rides include a donation	Reflects active engagement with feature
Transparency	Monthly	0%	100% transparent donation reports accessible	Builds trust with the user
Gamification Engagement	Monthly	0%	50% of users unlock badges or compete on leaderboard	Measures stickiness of feature
Repeat usage rate	Monthly	0%	25% of donors repeat donation for two days	Indicates long-term success

GTM (Go-To-Market) Strategy

To ensure widespread adoption of the *Community Impact Rides* feature, here is a focused GTM strategy. This includes audience segmentation, marketing campaigns, incentives, and partnerships to drive awareness, engagement, and long-term impact.

This strategy focuses on:

- 🎯 Identifying the right audience personas
- 📣 Deploying multi-channel marketing campaigns
- 🎁 Providing meaningful incentives to boost early adoption
- 🤝 Partnering with relevant organizations to scale social impact

Segmentation

Segment	Description	Key Traits
Millennials	Aware, urban, working professionals	Empathetic, conscious spenders
Working Parents	Want to model social good for their kids	Seek impact-driven brands
Eco-conscious Users	Ride Ola to reduce carbon footprint	Likely to support social change
Wallet Users	Ola Money active users	Comfortable with micro-donations

Marketing Campaigns

Channel	Idea
In-App Popups	“Every ride can change lives! 🌍 Enable Community Impact today.”
Email Campaigns	You ride, we donate. Together, we make a difference.” Include impact stats and featured causes.
Social Media	Short videos from riders/NGOs sharing impact. “My ₹10 brought water to 50 kids.”
Influencer Marketing	Partner with eco-influencers & local changemakers to promote cause

🎁 Incentives

- 🎁 **Early Adopter Badge:** Users who use the feature 3 times in a week get an exclusive badge.
- 💰 **₹20 Cashback:** First-time users of the feature get Ola Money cashback.

 **Monthly Leaderboard:** Top contributors shown on app homepage with rewards (like ₹100 ride credit).

 Partnerships

Partner Type	Examples	Value
Local NGOs	Teach for India, Robinhood Army, Swachh Bharath groups	Trusted local change
CSR Sponsors	Eco-product brands	Matching donation and cobranding
Government Programs	State & Municipal Drives	Legitimacy & scale
